Getting More Information about Ruby

As the volume of the Ruby libraries has grown, it has become impossible to document them all in one book; the standard library that comes with Ruby now contains more than 9,000 methods.

The official Ruby documentation is at https://docs.ruby-lang.org, with official pages for the Ruby 3.2 core library at https://ruby-doc.org/core-3.2.0 and the standard library at https://ruby-doc.org/stdlib-3.2.0. In Ruby 3.2, irb will also give you documentation of standard method names as you type.

Much of this documentation is generated from comments in the source code using a tool called RubyDoc, which we'll look at in Chapter 19, Documenting Ruby, on page 315 The RubyDoc site at https://www.rubydoc.info contains documentation for Ruby projects that use RubyDoc. Third-party libraries in the Ruby world are called *gems*, and the official listing of Ruby Gems is at https://rubygems.org, we'll talk lots more about gems in Chapter 15, Ruby Gems, on page 251.

There is also a command-line tool for the Ruby core documentation called ri. To find the documentation for a class, type ri <classname>. For example, the following is the beginning of the summary information for the String class. If you type ri with no arguments, you get a prompt asking you for a class.

```
= String < Object

------------------------------------------------------------------------
= Includes:
Comparable (from ruby core)

(from ruby core)
------------------------------------------------------------------------

A String object has an arbitrary sequence of bytes, typically
representing text or binary data. A String object may be created using
String::new or as literals.

String objects differ from Symbol objects in that Symbol objects are
designed to be used as identifiers, instead of text or data.
```

It goes on to list all the methods of String.

You can also try a method name:

```
$ ri strip

= .strip

(from ruby core)
=== Implementation from String
------------------------------------------------------------------------
  str.strip   -> new_str

------------------------------------------------------------------------

Returns a copy of the receiver with leading and trailing whitespace
removed.

Whitespace is defined as any of the following characters: null,
horizontal tab, line feed, vertical tab, form feed, carriage return,
```